PERSONAL THREAT MODEL

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Engagement: Personal Threat Modelling Exercise

Methodology: Assets > Adversaries > Capabilities > Mitigations

Account providers and personal identifiers have been generalised for publication.

1. WHO ARE YOU?

Role/Occupation: Student

Public profile: LinkedIn; Instagram profile (private)

Location: United States

Notable factors: Manages own investments through an online brokerage account.

2. WHAT ARE YOU PROTECTING?

CROWN JEWELS (irreplaceable or maximum damage if lost)

- Primary email account: used for MFA/recovery across bank, brokerage, social media, and cloud document storage
- Bank account login: 2FA via SMS + Face ID
- Brokerage account: 2FA via email
- Cloud document account: holds scanned copies of important (likely ID-type) documents

HIGH-VALUE (significant inconvenience or reputational damage)

- Social media account: linked to primary email
- Patient portal: full health records
- Phone: holds Face ID and receives SMS 2FA codes for the bank
- Laptop/computer: used to access all accounts above

LOWER-VALUE (annoying to lose, replaceable)

- Streaming account
- Reddit account

3. WHO MIGHT WANT TO HARM YOU?

OPPORTUNISTIC ATTACKERS (cast wide nets, take what's easy)

[x] Phishing campaigns targeting your email provider

[x] Smishing (SMS phishing) targeting your phone/bank

[x] Credential stuffing against reused passwords

TARGETED CRIMINAL (specifically picked you for financial gain)

[ ] Business email compromise via your work role

[ ] Identity theft using your public information

[ ] Ransomware via spear-phishing

PERSONAL ADVERSARY (someone with personal motivation)

[ ] Ex-partner with shared account history

[ ] Disgruntled former colleague

[ ] Stalker or harasser

LARGER ACTORS (rare for most people; relevant if applicable)

[ ] Corporate espionage if you handle sensitive IP

[ ] State surveillance if you're a journalist/activist

4. WHAT CAN THEY DO?

Top realistic threats for your profile:

THREAT 1: Phishing of primary email

Likelihood: HIGH

Impact: HIGH

Vector: Fake "unusual sign-in" or account-suspension email, spoofed sender, captures login credentials on a fake page. This cascades into the bank, brokerage, cloud document and social media accounts via email-based recovery.

THREAT 2: Smishing / SIM swap targeting bank SMS 2FA

Likelihood: HIGH

Impact: HIGH

Vector: Fake "suspicious charge" text with a link to a fake bank login, or a SIM swap against the mobile carrier that intercepts SMS 2FA codes. (Face ID protects the device, not a web session on another device.)

THREAT 3: Cascading takeover of the brokerage account via email

Likelihood: MEDIUM

Impact: HIGH

Vector: Once the primary email is compromised (Threat 1), an attacker triggers a brokerage password reset. The 2FA code lands in the same compromised inbox.

5. WHAT WILL YOU DO ABOUT IT?

ALREADY IN PLACE

[x] 2FA (SMS + Face ID) on bank account

[x] 2FA (email-based) on brokerage account

TO DO THIS WEEK

- [x] Confirm what MFA is currently on the primary email; upgrade to an authenticator app or hardware key
- [x] Confirm whether the cloud document account has MFA enabled

TO DO THIS MONTH

- [x] Add a non-email second factor (authenticator app or hardware key) to the brokerage account
- [x] Move bank 2FA from SMS to an authenticator app
- [x] Set a port-out PIN with the mobile carrier to reduce SIM-swap risk

ACCEPTING THE RISK ON

None identified from the information given.

6. WHAT YOU ARE NOT TRYING TO DEFEND AGAINST

Not defending against nation-state surveillance, sustained physical surveillance, insider threats, or targeted attacks from a known personal adversary. None of these were identified as applicable based on the information given. This scope should be revisited if that changes (for example, a specific conflict arises, or public visibility increases).